

SPY AND COVERT FORCES GUNS

The **Special Operations Executive (SOE)** was a British organization specializing in covert operations. Along with its American counterpart, the Office of Strategic Services (OSS), the SOE inserted commandos and agents into Occupied Europe during World War II. These forces were frequently armed with weapons featuring sound suppressors (silencers) that allowed stealth tactics to be implemented. Often, the OSS dropped cheap, single-use pistols, such as the Liberator, from aircraft to arm partisan forces until they could secure standard-issue weapons from enemy forces.

► WRIST PISTOL

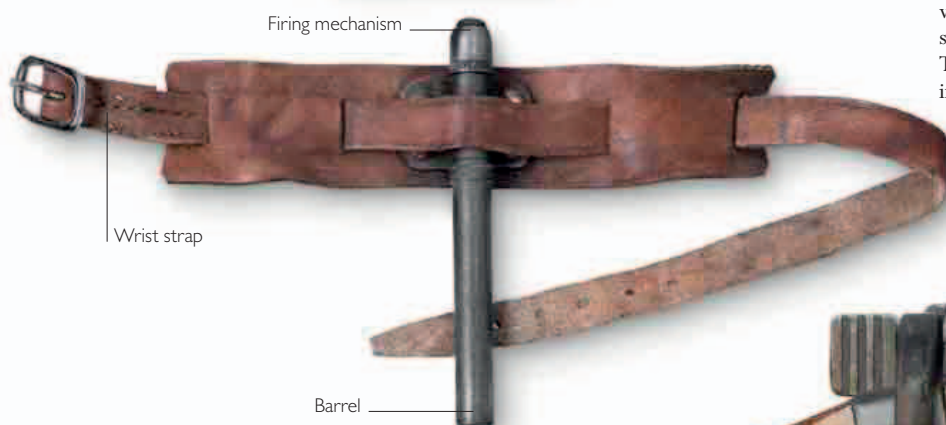
Date 1939–45

Origin UK

Barrel 1in (2.54cm)

Caliber .25in

This small, .25in-caliber firing device was designed to be worn on the wrist of SOE personnel, so that it was readily available without having to be held. It was fired by a string attached to the inside of a shirt or jacket.



▲ DE LISLE CARBINE

Date 1942

Origin UK

Barrel 8½in (20.9cm)

Caliber .45in

Designed by William Godfray de Lisle, this carbine is recognized as one of the quietest firearms ever made. It incorporates an integral sound suppressor around its barrel, and the report made when it is fired is inaudible except to the user. Though made in severely limited quantities, it saw service with British commandos during World War II, as well as afterward.



▲ HIGH STANDARD MODEL B WITH SILENCER

Date 1932

Origin US

Barrel 9in (23cm)

Caliber .22in

Of the guns made by the High Standard Manufacturing Company, one of the first was the Model B. It was a highly accurate .22in handgun designed for casual target shooting, but also found military applications. Unlike the Model A target pistol, which was similar but had adjustable sights, the Model B had fixed sights. This gun was used by OSS agents in World War II.



◀ FP-45 LIBERATOR PISTOL

Date 1942

Origin US

Barrel 4in (10cm)

Caliber .45in

Designed by the OSS as a simple and very cheap gun, the Liberator was intended to be paraded to resistance groups. It had 10 rounds of ammunition and was delivered with illustrated strip instructions for use.

